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A screenshot from the Quake 4 gameplay. Screenshot copyright: Alan Hopf, <http://www.flickr.com/people/psycho11/>. The image is released under Creative Commons Attribution 2.0 Generic License.

Tools to Develop AAA Games

In an earlier article titled 'Getting Started with Game Development', published in the December 2009 issue of LFY, we looked at the skeletal structure of a game, and had a cursory glance over some open source libraries and tools. This time around, we will look at five specific open source tools that are used frequently in many AAA titles.

To begin with, let us highlight the key functions within the game. Every time you run a game, a piece of software that is called the game engine loads itself into the memory. The game engine is like a kernel for the game. It will manage all resources, levels and your in-game progression. Everything that you see, hear or do, is managed by the

engine. The engine itself is a collection of services that provide these capabilities.

Once the engine is loaded, it uses the rendering subsystem to set your screen and start the game interface—legal screens, intros and menu systems. Using this rendering and the game logic through the game engine, you begin your gaming session. Everything that you see is taken care of